





OLD-WORLD CHARM
With visitors that included Mahatma Gandhi and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, the Diwans Bungalow, architect I.M. Kadri's ancestral home, is now a mix of the old and new

living room is a verandah overlooking a small but lush garden. It has a swing typical of Gujarati homes. Kadri's mother used to be parked on the swing for most of the day, and ran her household from there. The vernacular layout has now been transformed to create a home with independent suites. And, of course, mod cons have been added.

Kadri's father was associated with the freedom movement and, over the years, Diwans Bungalow has hosted several dignitaries. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was a regular. Mahatma Gandhi rested here before setting out in a historic procession to set up the Sabarmati Ashram across the river. *Farshi baithaks* (floor meetings) were conducted in the large living room. Abdul Ghaffar Khan (Frontier Gandhi) always preferred staying here because he could get non-vegetarian fare. The family retainer still rustles up a mean *khatta gosht*.

Today, this well-loved home is a boutique stay managed by jüSTa Hotels, so you, too, can experience the charmed life through the prism of heritage.